

Deliberation and Learning: Evidence From Deliberative Polls

Robert C. Luskin, Gaurav Sood, and James S. Fishkin

Working draft

Abstract

Among the great virtues ascribed to deliberation is learning. We ask how much participants in Deliberative Polls learn, whether taking part causes the learning, and who learns. In four Deliberative Polls with control groups, held in seven countries, participation raised factual knowledge by .46 standard deviations (95% interval .34 to .58); in the one poll followed for a year, 45% of the effect remained. Across 22 polls without controls, the share of items answered correctly rose by .130 [.099, .161], about twice as much face to face as online. Participants who start out knowing less, and those without degrees, gain somewhat more from participation. Small groups are composed as if at random, and who is in one's group, including how much the others know, has no detectable effect on learning.

1 Introduction

Among the great virtues commonly ascribed to deliberation is learning. The participants learn about the topics under discussion and, to a lesser degree, incidentally, about related ones. They learn not only relevant facts but the arguments for and against particular alternatives and what other people unlike themselves, their circumstances, and their ways of thinking are like. This is helpful, both at the individual level, for discerning what policies most closely accord with one's values and interests and voting accordingly, and at the aggregate level, for forming "authentic" majorities—majorities that "know what they are doing" (Luskin 2003). How much citizens know shapes what they prefer and how they vote (Converse 1964; Bartels 1996; Althaus 1998; Delli Carpini and Keeter 1996), even on foreign policy (Aldrich et al. 1989; Foyle 2004), though information shortcuts can partly stand in for knowledge (Popkin 1991; Lupia 1994).

The expectation of learning follows directly from the nature of "deliberation," conventionally construed as discussion, but not just any discussion (Fishkin and Luskin 2005). While definitions vary, deliberation is generally viewed as normatively elevated discussion—in which, among other things, the participants clarify and refine their preferences by open-mindedly weighing competing arguments. As part of that weighing, they absorb factual information and sift out misinformation.

Or so the theory runs. But how much do participants actually learn, is it the deliberation that teaches them, and who learns the most? We examine learning of relevant facts. This is not the only sort of learning involved, but it is the easiest to measure, and it is both important in itself and positively correlated with the rest.

Deliberative Polls teach. In four polls that surveyed a control group alongside the participants—two in the United States, one in Tanzania, and one across six middle-income countries—taking part raised factual knowledge by .46 standard deviations of the controls' initial knowledge, and in the one poll re-interviewed a year later, 45% of that effect remained. Earlier studies of Deliberative

Polls and other forums found that participants learn a lot (Luskin et al. 2002; Barabas 2004; Sturgis et al. 2005; Esterling et al. 2011; Theuwis et al. 2025), but most compared participants before and after, without a comparison group. We add two things. Participation helps those who start out knowing less somewhat more. And because small groups are composed as if at random, group composition is a natural experiment, and it shows no effect of one’s groupmates on how much one learns.

2 Deliberative Polling and Learning

Deliberative Polling (Fishkin 1991, 1995; Luskin et al. 2002) aims to capture fuller-information, more thoughtful opinions than those expressed in ordinary polls. In very brief, a Deliberative Poll interviews and assembles, as many as are willing of, a random sample to deliberate some policy or electoral choice, in alternating small group discussions and plenary question-and-answer sessions with panels of competing experts, and then re-measures the sample’s opinions at the end. These latter are frequently different, both at the individual level and in the aggregate, from what they were before deliberating. The absolute net change is statistically significant nearly three-quarters of the time and averages nearly .1 on a 0–1 scale (Luskin et al. 2007).

This design, admittedly a particular embodiment of deliberation, affords additional opportunities and incentives to learn. The participants are provided with carefully balanced briefing documents, rehearsing the arguments each side would make. There is usually a section of basic background information, and the arguments embed each side’s pet facts—those most congenial to its arguments. In addition, the participants know from the moment they are first recruited that they will be attending the deliberation and that the deliberation (typically) will be an “Event,” capital “e”—away from home, usually televised or taped for later broadcast, often attended by high-profile policy experts or policy-makers in the role of observers or panelists. Thus, motivated by a desire to “do well,” many participants use the weeks between their recruitment and the event itself to prepare—not only by reading the briefing materials but by paying heightened attention to stories about the topic in the media, by talking more with friends, family, and coworkers about it, and even, in some cases, by researching it in the library or online.

So if knowledge, like its close relative “sophistication,” depends on the confluence of cognitive ability, motivation, and exposure to relevant information (Luskin 1990, 2002), the deliberation in Deliberative Polling stands to increase two of those three. There is not much to be done, in adulthood, about ability—and in fact we should want the participants to be representative in this, as in all other respects. But the treatment can and does affect motivation and exposure. Judging from past polls, that is enough to produce considerable, sometimes dramatic learning (Luskin et al. 2002; List et al. 2013).

The online design is intended to be as similar as possible to the face-to-face one, given the difference in mode. The deliberation is by voice rather than text, so as to capture as much as possible of deliberation’s social elements. The participants still “meet” in small groups, still led by trained moderators, and still question panels of policy experts and policy makers. They still receive briefing materials. They are still a representative sample—sometimes randomly sampled offline, with “nonusers” receiving free access, including free equipment, to get them online, sometimes drawn from online panels and matched to approximate a random sample. On the other hand, deliberating by voice, even by video, online can never capture the full richness and complexity of in-person interactions; the discussions are interrupted, spread over a period of weeks, with much greater possibility of real-world intrusion, and the assignment to small groups is perforce constrained by

possible meeting times. All these differences may act to weaken the online treatment’s effects (Luskin et al. 2006; Iyengar et al. 2005).

3 Data

We use two kinds of data (Table 1; Appendix A lists every poll). For 22 polls held between 1994 and 2009 we have each participant’s proportion of knowledge items answered correctly before (T1) and after (T2) deliberating, with small-group membership and demographics: 21 from the replication data for Luskin et al. (2022), and a poll in Marousi, Greece, in which a party chose its mayoral candidate, released here for the first time. A separate replication provides item batteries for 23 polls, 16 of which overlap that historical set (Cor and Sood 2016). Four more recent polls surveyed control groups.

The 21-poll respondent file is rebuilt from poll-level sources in the accompanying dp-data repository, where scoring decisions and corrections are documented. Those sources also provide respondent-linked answers to the knowledge items in both waves for all 21 polls; their item means reproduce the historical T1 and T2 scores. Marousi has respondent scores but no recovered individual item answers. The separate Cor–Sood learning replication uses 23 deposited item batteries, including seven polls outside the historical respondent file. Among the control studies, the two American files and the antimicrobial-resistance file contain item answers; the Tanzanian file used here contains a standardized knowledge index.

Table 1: Data. Participants and controls are panel respondents used in the analyses. Control groups are an uninvited random sample, or randomized; in the antimicrobial-resistance poll the treated group is the attendees.

Study	Design	Participants	Controls
21 Deliberative Polls, 1994–2009	Pre-post	5,869	
Marousi, Greece, 2006	Pre-post	146	
23 Deliberative Polls, item level	Pre-post	6,654	
America in One Room, 2019	Uninvited sample	523	844
America in One Room: Climate, 2021	Uninvited sample	962	671
Tanzania, 2015	Randomized	383	921
Antimicrobial Resistance, 2024	Randomized; attendees	1,280	1,139

The control groups differ in how they were formed. America in One Room and its 2021 climate successor interviewed a separate random sample that was never invited (Fishkin et al. 2021). The Tanzanian poll randomized villages to treatment or control and, within treated villages, individuals to deliberation or to the briefing materials alone (Sandefur et al. 2022). The poll on antimicrobial resistance, held online in Brazil, Colombia, India, Indonesia, Nigeria and Tanzania, randomized panel members after the first interview; the release contains the controls and the invitees who attended, but not the invitees who stayed home (Mendelson et al. 2026). The respondent scores and poll metadata come from dp-data. In this analysis we remove duplicate Primaries rows, treat implausible ages and specified missing values in the Marousi file as missing, and round two scores stored just above one.

4 Measuring Learning

We measure knowledge by closed-ended knowledge questions, mostly multiple choice, in some cases extracted from party or candidate placements, and in a few cases true-false (Luskin 1987; Luskin and Bullock 2005; Price 1999; Mondak 1999, 2001). Appendix C lists the items. Correct responses are scored as 1, incorrect responses and “don’t knows” as 0 (Luskin and Bullock 2011), and these scores are then averaged across items to give the proportion answered correctly.

Table 2 models T2 knowledge conditional on T1 knowledge. Writing the outcome as $K_2 - K_1$ while retaining K_1 gives the same fit and the same coefficients for every other regressor; only the coefficient on K_1 falls by one. An unadjusted change-score model instead fixes the coefficient on K_1 in the T2 equation at one. It asks whether covariates predict the raw score difference, whereas Table 2 compares participants with the same measured starting score. The approaches can disagree when groups differ at baseline (Allison 1990; van Breukelen 2006). The observed score has a ceiling, and guessing and measurement error complicate its relationship to learning of the underlying facts (Luskin et al. 2016). We therefore treat the T1 coefficient as an association between measured scores, not an estimate of how prior knowledge causes learning.

Closed-ended items invite guessing, which inflates K_1 and can hide learning. The latent class model of Cor and Sood (2016) separates, item by item, respondents who knew the answer, learned it, or guessed, assuming nobody forgets. Across the 23 polls with item-level data, its estimates of learning average .208, against a raw .159.

5 How Much Do Participants Learn, and Does Participating Cause It?

Figure 1 puts all the evidence on one scale, standard deviations of T1 knowledge. Panel A shows the mean gain in each of the 22 polls without a control group; panel B shows the effect of participation in the four polls with one.

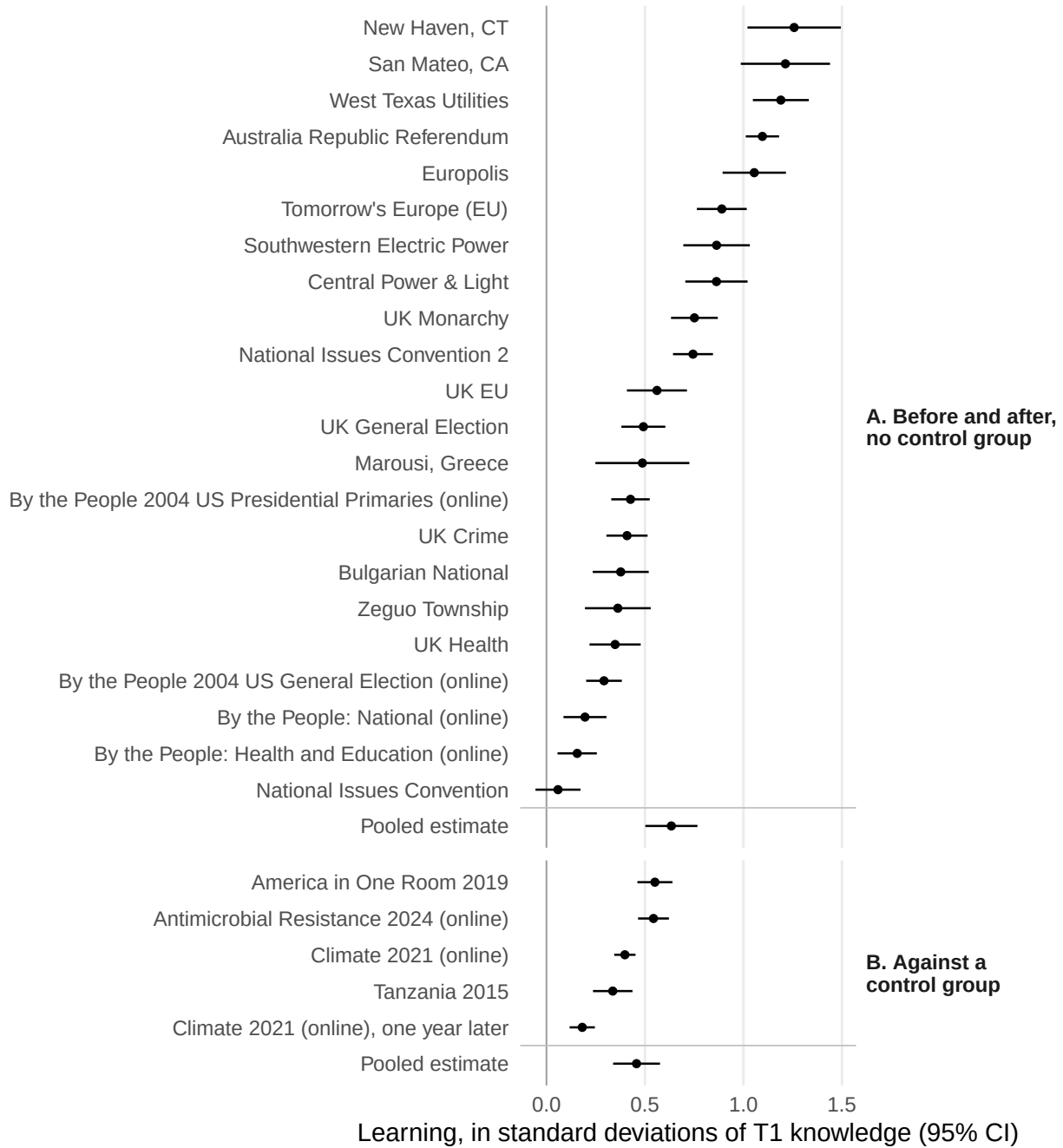


Figure 1: Learning in every poll, in standard deviations of T1 knowledge, with 95% intervals. A: mean T2 minus T1 gain among participants, scaled by the poll's T1 standard deviation. B: effect of participation, from a regression of T2 on treatment and T1 knowledge, scaled by the control group's T1 standard deviation; Tanzanian standard errors are clustered by village. Pooled estimates are from Bayesian random-effects meta-analyses.

Every poll shows learning. Raw gains range from .012 to .288 of the items; pooled, the proportion correct rose by .130 [.099, .161], or .63 [.50, .77] standard deviations. The pooling is a Bayesian random-effects meta-analysis: each poll's mean gain is its true gain plus sampling error, true gains are normally distributed around an overall mean, the prior on the mean is flat and that on the

between-poll standard deviation half-normal with scale .1 (Röver 2020). Face-to-face polls produced about twice the gain of online ones (.145 [.113, .177] against .064 [-.002, .131]; Appendix Table 4).

A pre-post gain alone does not show that deliberation taught anything: participants take the same quiz twice and live through weeks of news. The control groups provide a benchmark, and participation still teaches. Adjusting for T1 knowledge, it added .142 (.012) to the proportion correct in America in One Room, .121 (.008) in the 2021 climate poll, and .125 (.009) in the antimicrobial-resistance poll, where the country estimates range from -.04 in Tanzania to .31 in Nigeria. In Tanzania’s national poll, deliberation raised a standardized knowledge index by .335 (.051) standard deviations, matching the published estimate (Sandefur et al. 2022). Pooled, the effect is .46 [.34, .58] standard deviations. A year after the climate poll, attendees still knew .055 more than controls (s.e. .010), 45% of the immediate effect. The controls gained .01, .03 and .02 of the items in the three studies scored that way.

The designs differ in what they rule out. Tanzania randomized villages to an intervention or control, then randomized individuals in intervention villages to deliberation or information alone. Its treatment comparisons are causal under this assignment. Among those assigned to deliberation, the knowledge index rose by .718; in control villages, it rose by .510. The difference in changes is .209 (.095), compared with .335 (.051) after adjusting T2 for T1. Standard errors account for village assignment. The information-only arm gained .637, a difference of .127 (.102) from control.

The antimicrobial-resistance poll randomized invitations, but its treated group here is the attendees, who were 23 to 92% of invitees depending on the country. Attendees gained .125 of the items and randomized controls .022; the difference in changes is .103 (.010). This comparison includes selection into attendance. The two American polls likewise compare attendees with separately drawn, uninvited controls. In America in One Room, attendees answered .458 of T1 items correctly against .378 for invitees who stayed home; in the climate poll the figures were .686 and .579. Their differences in changes are .131 (.012) and .093 (.009), respectively. Adjusting for T1 and comparing changes impose different restrictions on baseline differences; neither resolves selection into attendance.

Does deliberation add anything to the briefing materials? In Tanzania, deliberation and the briefing materials alone were randomized among individuals in the same villages. Deliberation added .205 (.058) standard deviations adjusting for T1 knowledge, but only .081 (.081) in the difference of gains, because the deliberation arm happened to start .16 standard deviations higher. Discussion probably helps; this one comparison cannot say by how much.

6 Who Learns?

6.1 Regressors and hypotheses

Our explanatory variables vary by level of aggregation—some individual-level, some group-level, some poll-level—and substantively, in the degree to which they revolve around motivation versus ability versus exposure to relevant information. All are measured before deliberation.

Initial knowledge (K_1). The information-rich tend to get information-richer. The more one knows going in, the more one tends to learn and thus know going out. Absent ceiling effects, the coefficient should be > 1 ; given them, it may be < 1 . Prior knowledge on a particular topic improves people’s ability to comprehend new information, enabling them to extract the central elements of a message and draw appropriate inferences efficiently (Eckhardt et al. 1991; Recht and Leslie 1988). Prior

knowledge also enhances people’s ability to store new information on that topic and retrieve it later (Cooke et al. 1993; Fiske et al. 1990; Hambrick 2003; McGraw and Pinney 1990; Recht and Leslie 1988; Schneider et al. 1993). So the less political information individuals have stored in memory, the more difficult it is for them to acquire new information.

Education. Education, qua years of schooling, is distinct from, and only moderately correlated with, political knowledge. Controlling for cognitive ability, with which it is more strongly correlated, its effect on knowledge appears negligible (Luskin 1990). But absent a separate measure of cognitive ability, it can roughly proxy the latter. Naturally, we expect it to have a positive effect. There may, however, be some mutual substitution with initial knowledge. People who know enough already may not need to be as bright to learn a lot, and people who are bright enough may not need to know as much to do so. We measure education as comparably as possible across polls in three categories: less than high school graduation, high school graduation, and a bachelor’s degree or more.

Gender and age. These demographic variables exhibit real-world political knowledge gaps, with men knowing more than women and older people more than younger ones (Delli Carpini and Keeter 1996). Age is measured in decades and gender as a dummy scored 1 for women.

Proportion of women. Whether from greater comfort, more widely shared cognitive or communication style, or lower stereotype threat (Steele 1997), women may learn more in small groups containing more women. We calculate the proportion excluding the participant herself.

Mode. Online deliberation, with its thinner exposure to other participants, may be, either intrinsically or at least in its current instantiations, a somewhat etiolated version of the face-to-face treatment (Luskin et al. 2006). It is therefore plausible that people learn less from online deliberations.

Group size. The number of people in the participant’s small group may affect the quality of the deliberation, with larger groups arguably making for a less informative experience. As group size increases, attention may wander, and participants may not learn all that they hear (Latané et al. 1979).

Group knowledge. Participants may learn more from the other members of their small group when the latter know more. This suggests using the mean knowledge of the group’s other members. But what should matter is not how much the other group members know but how much they know about the particular facts the participant does not already know. So where the item-level data allow, we also measure group knowledge as the other members’ mean T1 score on the items the participant answered incorrectly at T1. This measure is undefined for participants who answered every T1 item correctly. It is unavailable for Marousi, where individual item answers have not been recovered.

Heterogeneity of opinion. In the real world, people often know congenial but not uncongenial facts—those commonly cited by those sharing their views but not those commonly cited by those holding opposing views. Part of deliberation’s effect on learning may consist in getting people to note and accept (if, in many cases, still argue around) uncongenial facts. This can be expected to occur mainly on site. Participants learn a great deal in anticipation of the event, but the learning at that stage is mainly of congenial facts (Hansen 2004). On site, the participants find it harder to avoid confronting the uncongenial ones. This may happen more, the more opposing points of view are represented and argued in the small group—the more attitudinally heterogeneous the group is. We gauge this as the generalized variance, the determinant of the covariance matrix, of the group’s

policy attitudes (Anderson 2003).

Attitude extremity. Participants starting with more extreme views may have shuttered out more uncongenial facts, leaving them with more ground for deliberation to make up. We measure extremity as the mean, across attitude indices j , of $|A_{ij} - .5|$, where A_{ij} is the i th respondent’s score on the j th index.

Reading the briefing materials. One of the main information vectors is the briefing document sent to participants shortly after recruitment, normally well in advance of the on-site deliberations. It provides some background facts and lays out the major arguments for and against given policy options, which embed additional facts congenial to each argument. The historical analysis file carries a respondent-level reading report in only four polls: National Issues Convention, National Issues Convention 2, Tomorrow’s Europe, and San Mateo. The retained source surveys contain the report in five more: Australia, Central Power & Light, Southwestern Electric Power, West Texas Utilities, and Europolis. We link all nine reports to respondents, score their ordered categories from zero to one using the source-specific response scales, and analyze them in a separate model. We have not recovered a comparable source-linked report for the other 13 polls; this does not mean their participants received no briefing.

Issue salience. More salient issues, to which many participants have already given some attention, exhibit decidedly less net attitude change (Luskin et al. 2007) and fall shorter of single-peakedness (List et al. 2013). We suspect they also, and relatedly, show less learning: there is less left to learn. We proxy salience by the participants’ mean T1 knowledge.

6.2 Model

The nested structure of the data, with individuals clustered in small groups clustered in polls, suggests a hierarchical linear model (Raudenbush and Bryk 2002) with random intercepts by small group and poll:

$$K_{igd2} = \beta_0 + \alpha_g + \gamma_d + \mathbf{x}'_{igd}\beta + u_{igd},$$

where i , g and d index individuals, small groups and polls; $\alpha_g \sim N(0, \sigma_\alpha^2)$ and $\gamma_d \sim N(0, \sigma_\gamma^2)$ are unmodeled parts of the intercept; $\mathbf{x}_{igd}$ holds the regressors above; and $u_{igd} \sim N(0, \sigma_u^2)$ is a disturbance. We estimate it by maximum likelihood (Bates et al. 2015). The main model uses 5,832 participants in 412 groups in 22 polls.

6.3 Whom participation helps most

Before turning to the model, the control-group studies let us ask whose knowledge participation raises most, a causal question the pre-post data cannot answer. Adding the product of treatment and centred T1 knowledge, the effect of participation is smaller for those who start knowing more, by -.15 (.04) per unit of T1 knowledge in America in One Room and -.25 (.03) in the climate poll, with no difference in the other two studies (Appendix Table 5). Part of this is the ceiling: those who start high have less room to show a gain. Participation also helped those without a bachelor’s degree somewhat more in the climate and antimicrobial-resistance polls (-.047 (.016) and -.043 (.020)), though not in America in One Room. Deliberation narrows knowledge gaps modestly; it does not widen them.

6.4 Who knows more after deliberation?

Table 2: T2 proportion correct conditional on T1. Maximum likelihood coefficients (standard errors).

	All polls	Linked items	Reading reports
Intercept	.057 (.049)	.080 (.049)	.513 (.068)
T1 knowledge	.472 (.025)	.489 (.028)	.513 (.091)
High school	.118 (.016)	.124 (.017)	.138 (.033)
BA or more	.191 (.018)	.199 (.019)	.206 (.034)
T1 x high school	-.040 (.029)	-.048 (.032)	-.168 (.094)
T1 x BA or more	-.092 (.032)	-.108 (.035)	-.175 (.094)
Age (decades)	-.003 (.002)	-.003 (.002)	-.008 (.003)
Attitude extremity	-.069 (.030)	-.086 (.031)	-.187 (.040)
Group size	.000 (.001)	.000 (.001)	-.001 (.002)
Groupmates' mean T1	.078 (.051)		-.066 (.075)
Groupmates' T1 on missed questions		.010 (.029)	
Opinion heterogeneity	.007 (.086)	-.015 (.088)	.011 (.135)
Female	-.024 (.023)	-.023 (.024)	-.052 (.034)
Group share women	-.009 (.035)	-.016 (.036)	-.038 (.051)
Female x group share women	.031 (.044)	.033 (.046)	.065 (.064)
Online	-.099 (.033)	-.108 (.032)	
Poll mean T1	.524 (.105)	.563 (.094)	
Briefing reading			.059 (.011)
Participants	5,832	5,570	2,626
Small groups	412	397	191
Polls	22	21	9
Marginal R-squared	0.388	0.367	0.406
Conditional R-squared	0.438	0.416	0.413

Notes. The linked-items model averages groupmates' T1 correctness on questions the respondent answered incorrectly at T1; it is undefined when the respondent answered every T1 question correctly. Marousi lacks respondent-level item answers. The all-polls and linked-items models have poll and small-group random intercepts. The reading-reports model has poll fixed effects and small-group random intercepts. Marginal R^2 covers fixed effects; conditional R^2 includes random intercepts.

Table 2 shows the estimates. Among participants with less than a high-school education, those with higher T1 scores also score higher at T2 (.472 (.025)); the coefficient below one corresponds to smaller observed gains at higher T1 scores in this reference category. The score ceiling and measurement error complicate an interpretation as differences in actual learning. A bachelor's degree is associated with a T2 advantage of .191 (.018) for a participant who starts with nothing right. That advantage narrows as T1 knowledge rises (-.092 (.032) per unit of T1 knowledge). The age estimate is small and negative (-.003 (.002) per decade), with a 95% confidence interval that includes zero. Participants in online polls score lower at T2 (-.099 (.033)), conditional on T1, and those in polls whose participants start out knowing more score higher (.524 (.105)). In the nine polls with a reading report, those who said they read more of the briefing materials scored higher at T2 (.059 (.011)), though reading is itself a choice. Attitude extremity and opinion heterogeneity have no detectable effect.

6.5 Do small groups matter?

If participants learn from each other, those placed with more knowledgeable groupmates should learn more. Estimating this requires that groupmates' characteristics be unrelated to one's own, which random assignment to groups ensures and self-selection does not. Organizers intend random assignment. We test it by regressing each participant's characteristic on the mean among the other members of the group, controlling for the mean among the other members of the poll, without which the test is biased toward finding negative sorting (Guryan et al. 2009). The coefficients are near zero for T1 knowledge (.017 (.016)), gender (-.016 (.020)) and age (-.007 (.025)), and small for a bachelor's degree (.042 (.030)). Groups are composed as if at random.

That makes group composition a natural experiment. Within each of 23 polls, the 22 above and America in One Room, we regress T2 knowledge on the other members' mean T1 knowledge, controlling for one's own and the poll's, and pool the estimates (Figure 2). The pooled effect is .077 [-.039, .198]: at the upper end, a group whose other members answered ten more points of the T1 items correctly would raise one's T2 score by 2 points. The share of women in the group has no detectable effect either (.026 [-.014, .065]). Measured on the items each participant missed, which is closer to what one could learn from others, group knowledge again has no effect (.010 (.029) in the 21 polls with linked item data). Group knowledge measured after the deliberation would show an effect for the wrong reason: groupmates' T2 answers reflect the experience they shared with the participant (Manski 1993).

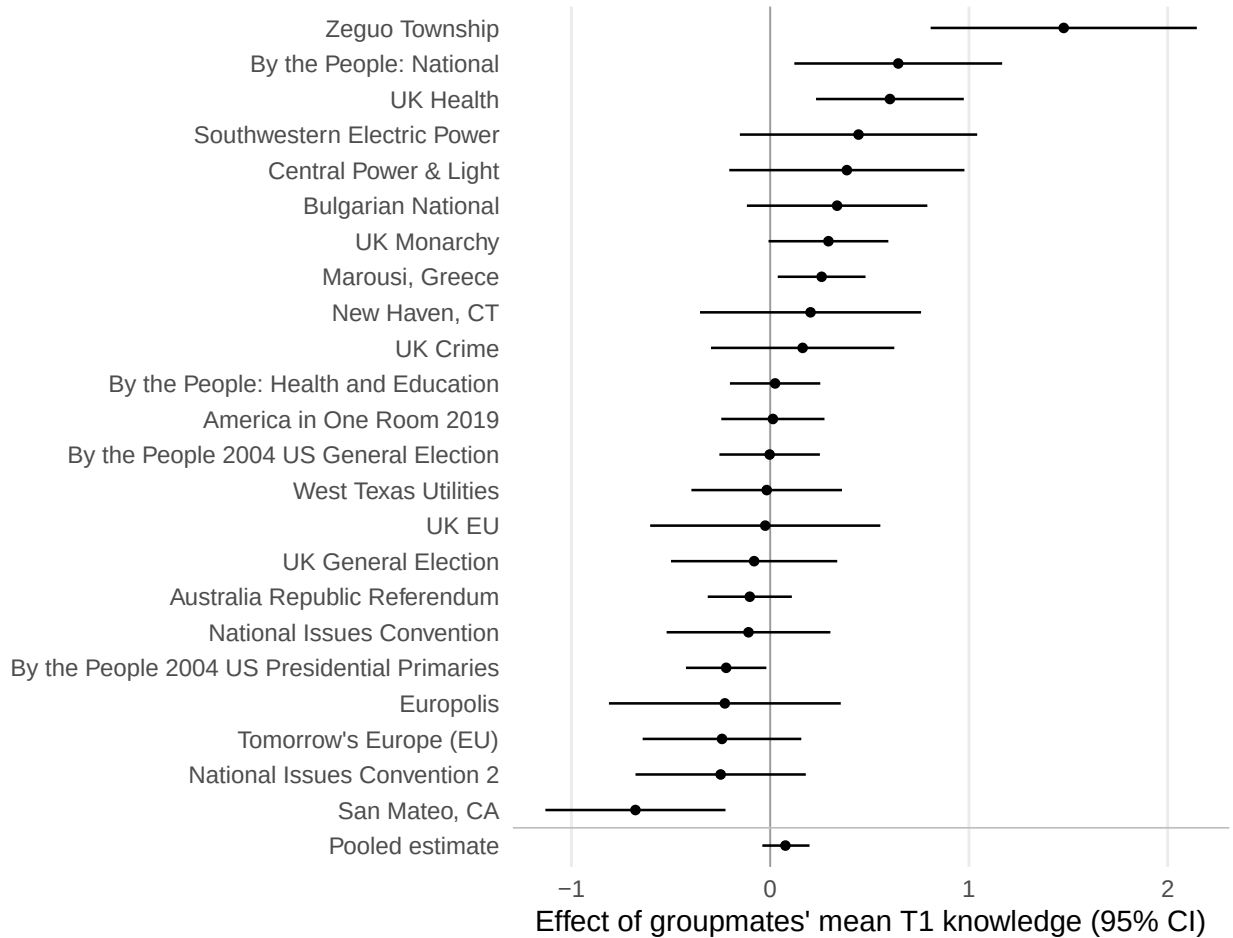


Figure 2: Effect of the other group members' mean T1 knowledge on own T2 knowledge, by poll, with 95% intervals. Each estimate controls for own T1 knowledge and the poll's leave-one-out mean, with standard errors clustered by small group; the pooled estimate is from a Bayesian random-effects meta-analysis.

7 Conclusion

Deliberative Polls raise what participants know by about half a standard deviation, and much of the gain lasts. The learning does not depend on whom participants happen to deliberate with, and it favours, if anything, those who start out knowing less. The simplest reading is that the whole event teaches, through the briefing materials, the expert sessions, the discussion, and the anticipation of taking part, rather than through particular groupmates.

Two limits remain. Only Tanzania randomized people to take part or not; elsewhere the comparison involves attendees, who differ from those who stay home. And the knowledge items are few and chosen by the organizers, so the gains are gains in the facts the event emphasized.

References

Aldrich, John H., John L. Sullivan, and Eugene Borgida. 1989. "Foreign Affairs and Issue Voting: Do Presidential Candidates 'Waltz Before a Blind Audience?'" *American Political Science*

- Review* 83 (1): 123–41. <https://doi.org/10.2307/1956437>.
- Allison, Paul D. 1990. “Change Scores as Dependent Variables in Regression Analysis.” *Sociological Methodology* 20: 93–114. <https://doi.org/10.2307/271083>.
- Althaus, Scott L. 1998. “Information Effects in Collective Preferences.” *American Political Science Review* 92 (3): 545–58. <https://doi.org/10.2307/2585480>.
- Anderson, T. W. 2003. *An Introduction to Multivariate Statistical Analysis*. 3rd ed. Wiley-Interscience.
- Barabas, Jason. 2004. “How Deliberation Affects Policy Opinions.” *American Political Science Review* 98 (4): 687–701. <https://doi.org/10.1017/s0003055404041425>.
- Bartels, Larry M. 1996. “Uninformed Votes: Information Effects in Presidential Elections.” *American Journal of Political Science* 40 (1): 194–230. <https://doi.org/10.2307/2111700>.
- Bates, Douglas, Martin Mächler, Ben Bolker, and Steve Walker. 2015. “Fitting Linear Mixed-Effects Models Using Lme4.” *Journal of Statistical Software* 67 (1). <https://doi.org/10.18637/jss.v067.i01>.
- Converse, Philip E. 1964. “The Nature of Belief Systems in Mass Publics.” In *Ideology and Discontent*, edited by David E. Apter. Free Press.
- Cooke, Nancy J., Robert S. Atlas, David M. Lane, and Robert C. Berger. 1993. “Role of High-Level Knowledge in Memory for Chess Positions.” *The American Journal of Psychology* 106 (3): 321–51. <https://doi.org/10.2307/1423181>.
- Cor, M. Ken, and Gaurav Sood. 2016. “Guessing and Forgetting: A Latent Class Model for Measuring Learning.” *Political Analysis* 24 (2): 226–42. <https://doi.org/10.1093/pan/mpw010>.
- Delli Carpini, Michael X., and Scott Keeter. 1996. *What Americans Know about Politics and Why It Matters*. Yale University Press.
- Eckhardt, Beverly B., Mary R. Wood, and Robin Smith Jacobvitz. 1991. “Verbal Ability and Prior Knowledge: Contributions to Adults’ Comprehension of Television.” *Communication Research* 18 (5): 636–49. <https://doi.org/10.1177/009365091018005004>.
- Esterling, K. M., M. A. Neblo, and D. M. J. Lazer. 2011. “Means, Motive, and Opportunity in Becoming Informed about Politics: A Deliberative Field Experiment with Members of Congress and Their Constituents.” *Public Opinion Quarterly* 75 (3): 483–503. <https://doi.org/10.1093/poq/nfr001>.
- Fishkin, James S. 1991. *Democracy and Deliberation: New Directions for Democratic Reform*. Yale University Press.
- Fishkin, James S. 1995. *The Voice of the People: Public Opinion and Democracy*. Yale University Press.

- Fishkin, James S., and Robert C. Luskin. 2005. "Experimenting with a Democratic Ideal: Deliberative Polling and Public Opinion." *Acta Politica* 40 (3): 284–98. <https://doi.org/10.1057/palgrave.ap.5500121>.
- Fishkin, James, Alice Siu, Larry Diamond, and Norman Bradburn. 2021. "Is Deliberation an Antidote to Extreme Partisan Polarization? Reflections on 'America in One Room'." *American Political Science Review* 115 (4): 1464–81. <https://doi.org/10.1017/s0003055421000642>.
- Fiske, Susan T., Richard R. Lau, and Richard A. Smith. 1990. "On the Varieties and Utilities of Political Expertise." *Social Cognition* 8 (1): 31–48. <https://doi.org/10.1521/soco.1990.8.1.31>.
- Foyle, Douglas C. 2004. "Leading the Public to War? The Influence of American Public Opinion on the Bush Administration's Decision to Go to War in Iraq." *International Journal of Public Opinion Research* 16 (3): 269–94. <https://doi.org/10.1093/ijpor/edh025>.
- Guryan, Jonathan, Kory Kroft, and Matthew J Notowidigdo. 2009. "Peer Effects in the Workplace: Evidence from Random Groupings in Professional Golf Tournaments." *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics* 1 (4): 34–68. <https://doi.org/10.1257/app.1.4.34>.
- Hambrick, David Z. 2003. "Why Are Some People More Knowledgeable Than Others? A Longitudinal Study of Knowledge Acquisition." *Memory & Cognition* 31 (6): 902–17. <https://doi.org/10.3758/bf03196444>.
- Hansen, Kasper M. 2004. *Deliberative Democracy and Opinion Formation*. University Press of Southern Denmark. <http://www.kaspermhansen.eu/Work/Hansen2004.pdf>.
- Iyengar, Shanto, Robert C. Luskin, and James S. Fishkin. 2005. *Deliberative Preferences in the Presidential Nomination Campaign: Evidence from an Online Deliberative Poll*. Working paper, Center for Deliberative Democracy, Stanford University. <http://cdd.stanford.edu/research/papers/2005/presidential-nomination.pdf>.
- Latané, Bibb, Kipling Williams, and Stephen Harkins. 1979. "Many Hands Make Light the Work: The Causes and Consequences of Social Loafing." *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology* 37 (6): 822–32. <https://doi.org/10.1037/0022-3514.37.6.822>.
- List, Christian, Robert C. Luskin, James S. Fishkin, and Iain McLean. 2013. "Deliberation, Single-Peakedness, and the Possibility of Meaningful Democracy: Evidence from Deliberative Polls." *The Journal of Politics* 75 (1): 80–95. <https://doi.org/10.1017/s0022381612000886>.
- Lupia, Arthur. 1994. "Shortcuts Versus Encyclopedias: Information and Voting Behavior in California Insurance Reform Elections." *American Political Science Review* 88 (1): 63–76. <https://doi.org/10.2307/2944882>.
- Luskin, Robert C. 1987. "Measuring Political Sophistication." *American Journal of Political Science* 31 (4): 856–99. <https://doi.org/10.2307/2111227>.
- Luskin, Robert C. 1990. "Explaining Political Sophistication." *Political Behavior* 12 (4): 331–61. <https://doi.org/10.1007/bf00992793>.

- Luskin, Robert C. 2002. "From Denial to Extenuation (and Finally Beyond): Political Sophistication and Citizen Performance." In *Thinking about Political Psychology*, edited by James H. Kuklinski. Cambridge University Press. <https://doi.org/10.1017/cbo9780511510632.010>.
- Luskin, Robert C. 2003. "The Heavenly Public: What Would a Fully Informed Citizenry Be Like?" In *Electoral Democracy*, edited by Michael B. MacKuen and George Rabinowitz. University of Michigan Press.
- Luskin, Robert C., and John G. Bullock. 2005. *Re(:)measuring Political Sophistication*. Paper presented at the annual meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago. <https://web.stanford.edu/class/polisci353/2004fall/reading/BullockPiece.doc>.
- Luskin, Robert C., and John G. Bullock. 2011. "'Don't Know' Means 'Don't Know': DK Responses and the Public's Level of Political Knowledge." *The Journal of Politics* 73 (2): 547–57. <https://doi.org/10.1017/s0022381611000132>.
- Luskin, Robert C., James S. Fishkin, and Kyu S. Hahn. 2007. *Deliberation and Net Attitude Change*. Paper presented at the ECPR General Conference, Pisa, Italy, September 6–8. <https://cdd.stanford.edu/mm/2007/deliberation-net-change.pdf>.
- Luskin, Robert C., James S. Fishkin, and Shanto Iyengar. 2006. *Considered Opinions on U.S. Foreign Policy: Evidence from Online and Face-to-Face Deliberative Polling*. Working paper, Center for Deliberative Democracy, Stanford University. <http://cdd.stanford.edu/research/papers/2006/foreign-policy.pdf>.
- Luskin, Robert C., James S. Fishkin, and Roger Jowell. 2002. "Considered Opinions: Deliberative Polling in Britain." *British Journal of Political Science* 32 (3): 455–87. <https://doi.org/10.1017/s0007123402000194>.
- Luskin, Robert C., Ariel Helfer, and Gaurav Sood. 2016. "Measuring Learning in Informative Processes." https://www.gsood.com/research/papers/k_gains.pdf.
- Luskin, Robert C., Gaurav Sood, James S. Fishkin, and Kyu S. Hahn. 2022. "Deliberative Distortions? Homogenization, Polarization, and Domination in Small Group Discussions." *British Journal of Political Science* 52 (3): 1205–25. <https://doi.org/10.1017/s0007123421000168>.
- Manski, Charles F. 1993. "Identification of Endogenous Social Effects: The Reflection Problem." *The Review of Economic Studies* 60 (3): 531. <https://doi.org/10.2307/2298123>.
- McGraw, Kathleen M., and Neil Pinney. 1990. "The Effects of General and Domain-Specific Expertise on Political Memory and Judgment." *Social Cognition* 8 (1): 9–30. <https://doi.org/10.1521/soco.1990.8.1.9>.
- Mendelson, Marc, Alice Siu, Louise Gough, Hamish Morrow, James Fishkin, and Sally Davies. 2026. "Understanding What Citizens Think about Antimicrobial Resistance: Deliberative Polling® in Six Middle-Income Countries." *Wellcome Open Research* 10 (May): 690. <https://doi.org/10.12688/wellcomeopenres.24803.2>.

- Mondak, Jeffery J. 1999. "Reconsidering the Measurement of Political Knowledge." *Political Analysis* 8 (1): 57–82. <https://doi.org/10.1093/oxfordjournals.pan.a029805>.
- Mondak, Jeffery J. 2001. "Developing Valid Knowledge Scales." *American Journal of Political Science* 45 (1): 224–38. <https://doi.org/10.2307/2669369>.
- Popkin, Samuel L. 1991. *The Reasoning Voter: Communication and Persuasion in Presidential Campaigns*. University of Chicago Press. <https://doi.org/10.7208/chicago/9780226772875.001.0001>.
- Price, Vincent. 1999. "Political Information." In *Measures of Political Attitudes*, edited by John P. Robinson, Phillip R. Shaver, and Lawrence S. Wrightsman. Academic Press.
- Raudenbush, Stephen W., and Anthony S. Bryk. 2002. *Hierarchical Linear Models: Applications and Data Analysis Methods*. 2nd ed. Sage.
- Recht, Donna R., and Lauren Leslie. 1988. "Effect of Prior Knowledge on Good and Poor Readers' Memory of Text." *Journal of Educational Psychology* 80 (1): 16–20. <https://doi.org/10.1037/0022-0663.80.1.16>.
- Röver, Christian. 2020. "Bayesian Random-Effects Meta-Analysis Using the Bayesmeta r Package." *Journal of Statistical Software* 93 (6). <https://doi.org/10.18637/jss.v093.i06>.
- Sandefur, Justin, Nancy Birdsall, James Fishkin, and Mujobu Moyo. 2022. "Democratic Deliberation and the Resource Curse: A Nationwide Experiment in Tanzania." *World Politics* 74 (4): 564–609. <https://doi.org/10.1017/s0043887122000090>.
- Schneider, Wolfgang, Hans Gruber, Andreas Gold, and Klaus Opwis. 1993. "Chess Expertise and Memory for Chess Positions in Children and Adults." *Journal of Experimental Child Psychology* 56 (3): 328–49. <https://doi.org/10.1006/jecp.1993.1038>.
- Steele, Claude M. 1997. "A Threat in the Air: How Stereotypes Shape Intellectual Identity and Performance." *American Psychologist* 52 (6): 613–29. <https://doi.org/10.1037/0003-066x.52.6.613>.
- Sturgis, Patrick, Caroline Roberts, and Nick Allum. 2005. "A Different Take on the Deliberative Poll: Information, Deliberation, and Attitude Constraint." *Public Opinion Quarterly* 69 (1): 30–65. <https://doi.org/10.1093/poq/nfi005>.
- Theuwis, Marie-Isabel, Carolien Van Ham, and Kristof Jacobs. 2025. "A Meta-Analysis of the Effects of Democratic Innovations on Participants' Attitudes, Behaviour and Capabilities." *European Journal of Political Research* 64 (2): 960–84. <https://doi.org/10.1111/1475-6765.12722>.
- van Breukelen, Gerard J. P. 2006. "ANCOVA Versus Change from Baseline: More Power in Randomized Studies, More Bias in Nonrandomized Studies." *Journal of Clinical Epidemiology* 59 (9): 920–25. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jclinepi.2006.02.007>.

A The Deliberative Polls

Table 3: The Deliberative Polls without control groups. Data: P, participant-level scores; I, item-level responses.

Poll	Year	Topic	Data
UK Crime	1994	Crime	P+I
UK EU	1995	Britain’s future in Europe	P+I
Central Power & Light	1996	Electricity choices	P+I
National Issues Convention	1996	Foreign and economic policy	P+I
Southwestern Electric Power	1996	Electricity choices	P+I
UK Monarchy	1996	Future of the monarchy	P+I
West Texas Utilities	1996	Electricity choices	P+I
UK General Election	1997	Electoral choice	P+I
UK Health	1998	National Health Service	P+I
Australia Republic Referendum	1999	Becoming a republic	P+I
Denmark: Euro	2000	Adopting the euro	I
Bulgarian National Crime Poll	2002	Crime and criminal justice	P+I
By the People: National (online)	2003	Foreign policy	P+I
National Issues Convention 2	2003	Foreign policy	P+I
By the People 2004 Online Primaries (online)	2004	Presidential primaries	I
By the People 2004 US General Election (online)	2004	Presidential election	P+I
By the People 2004 US Presidential Primaries (online)	2004	Presidential primaries	P+I
New Haven, CT	2004	Airport and regional tax sharing	P+I
By the People: Health and Education (online)	2005	Health care and education	P+I
Zeguo Township	2005	Local infrastructure projects	P+I
Marousi, Greece	2006	Choosing a mayoral candidate	P
By the People 2007 (online)	2007	Electoral reform	I
Northern Ireland	2007	Local education	I
Tomorrow’s Europe (EU)	2007	Pensions, globalization and enlargement	P+I
Vermont Energy	2007	Energy choices	I
San Mateo, CA	2008	Housing	P+I
Europolis	2009	Climate change and immigration	P+I
Michigan	2009	Economy and budget	I
California What’s Next	2011	Government reform	I

B Further results

Table 4: Bayesian random-effects meta-analysis of poll mean gains, in proportion correct

Model	Parameter	Median	2.5%	97.5%
Pooled	Mean gain	.130	.099	.161
Pooled	Between-poll SD	.070	.050	.096
By mode	Face-to-face	.145	.113	.177
By mode	Online	.064	-.002	.131
By mode	Between-poll SD	.064	.045	.088

Table 5: Heterogeneous effects of participation. Each row adds the product of treatment and the moderator to the regression of T2 on treatment and T1 knowledge.

Study	Moderator	Treatment x moderator	n
America in One Room 2019	T1 knowledge (centred)	-.155 (.041)	1,367
America in One Room 2019	Bachelor’s degree	.027 (.023)	1,367
America in One Room: Climate 2021	T1 knowledge (centred)	-.252 (.029)	1,633
America in One Room: Climate 2021	Bachelor’s degree	-.047 (.016)	1,633
Antimicrobial Resistance 2024	T1 knowledge (centred)	.043 (.038)	2,419
Antimicrobial Resistance 2024	Bachelor’s degree	-.043 (.020)	2,408
Tanzania 2015	T1 knowledge (centred)	-.018 (.051)	1,304

C Knowledge items

The 21 historical respondent batteries and 23 Cor–Sood item batteries overlap in 16 polls. Their baseline questions resolve to 224 distinct items in 28 polls; 123 items are shared by both batteries. The catalog and source references are maintained in `dp-data/metadata/items.csv`; this appendix is generated from that file. Wording is paraphrased where only source labels survive. Choices are transcribed where recoverable; Northern Ireland’s archived choice labels are truncated. A code in brackets identifies the scored baseline answer, and notes describe open-response coding. Marousi has respondent scores but no recovered person-item answers.

C.1 UK Crime (1994)

- **Can British courts sentence a murderer to death?** (true/false; source kw11). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [0].
- **Does Britain have the largest prison population in Western Europe?** (true/false; source kw21). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: True [1].
- **Does Britain have more prisoners serving life sentences than the rest of the European Community combined?** (true/false; source kw31). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: True [1].
- **Can a defendant be tried by jury in a local magistrates court?** (true/false; source kw41). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [0].

- **Is the number of members of Parliament about 100?** (true/false; source `pkw11`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [0].
- **Is the longest permitted interval between general elections four years?** (true/false; source `pkw21`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [0].
- **Is the British electoral system based on proportional representation?** (true/false; source `pkw31`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [0].

C.2 UK EU (1995)

- **Has the European Union recently expanded to 15 members?** (true/false; source `eusize1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: True [1].
- **Is Switzerland about to join the European Union?** (true/false; source `swiss1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].
- **Are British income tax rates decided in Brussels?** (true/false; source `inctax1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].
- **Are European Parliament elections held every five years?** (true/false; source `elect1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: True [1].
- **Are the Liberal Democrats the least favorable to the European Union of the three main British parties?** (true/false; source `ptyapp1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].

C.3 Central Power & Light (1996)

- **Which energy source produces the greatest amount of CPL electricity?** (multiple choice; source `source1`). Choices: 1: Coal | 2: Wind | 3: Natural Gas | 4: Fuel Oil | 5: Nuclear | 6: Solar | 99: dk. Scored correct: Natural Gas [3].
- **Which customer group uses the most CPL electricity?** (multiple choice; source `use1`). Choices: 1: Residential | 2: Commerical | 3: Industrial | 99: dk. Scored correct: Industrial [3].
- **Which CPL customer group pays the highest electric rates?** (multiple choice; source `rt1`). Choices: 1: Residential | 2: Commerical | 3: Industrial | 99: dk. Scored correct: Commerical [2].
- **Which electricity source produces the most air emissions?** (multiple choice; source `smog1`). Choices: 1: Nuclear | 2: Coal | 3: Natural Gas | 99: dk. Scored correct: Coal [2].
- **Which agency sets electric rates in Texas?** (open coded; source `setrt1`). Scored correct: PUC [1]. Open answer coded into source categories; code 1 (Public Utility Commission) scored correct. Other codes scored incorrect. See `R/respondent_utilities.R`.
- **How much profit do Texas electric utilities make on fuel?** (multiple choice; source `profit1`). Choices: 0: 0% | 1: 10% | 2: 20% | 3: 30% | 99: dk. Scored correct: 0% [0].
- **How much of the electric bill pays for fuel?** (multiple choice; source `pctful1`). Choices: 1: less than 20% | 2: 21-30% | 3: 31-40% | 4: 41-50% | 5: More Than 50% | 99: dk. Scored correct: 21-30% [2].

C.4 National Issues Convention (1996)

- **About what percentage of American children are born outside marriage?** (open numeric; source WEDLOCK1). Scored correct: 25-40 inclusive [25-40 inclusive]. Numeric response scored correct when within the inclusive interval shown in correct_codes; missing and out-of-range responses scored incorrect. See R/respondent_nic.R.
- **About what percentage of children live in single-parent households?** (open numeric; source AFDC1). Scored correct: 1-10 inclusive [1-10 inclusive]. Numeric response scored correct when within the inclusive interval shown in correct_codes; missing and out-of-range responses scored incorrect. See R/respondent_nic.R.
- **What was the unemployment rate over the previous ten years?** (open numeric; source UNEMP1). Scored correct: 5-10 inclusive [5-10 inclusive]. Numeric response scored correct when within the inclusive interval shown in correct_codes; missing and out-of-range responses scored incorrect. See R/respondent_nic.R.
- **Which listed purpose does the United States spend the most on?** (multiple choice; source SPEND1). Choices: 1: The space program | 2: Foreign aid | 3: National defense | 4: Agriculture subsidies | 8: Do not know. Scored correct: National defense [3].
- **Which listed country does the United States trade with most?** (multiple choice; source TRADE1). Choices: 1: Canada | 2: Japan | 3: Germany | 4: Mexico | 8: Do not know. Scored correct: Canada [1].
- **Had the United States sent ground troops to Iraq in the previous ten years?** (yes/no; source TROOPSA1). Choices: Yes | No. Scored correct: Yes [1].
- **Had the United States sent ground troops to Somalia in the previous ten years?** (yes/no; source TROOPSB1). Choices: Yes | No. Scored correct: Yes [1].
- **Had the United States sent ground troops to Rwanda in the previous ten years?** (yes/no; source TROOPSC1). Choices: Yes | No. Scored correct: No [0].
- **Had the United States sent ground troops to Bosnia in the previous ten years?** (yes/no; source TROOPSD1). Choices: Yes | No. Scored correct: Yes [1].
- **Where were Republicans on the liberal to conservative scale?** (placement scale; source POLREP1). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: Slightly conservative | Conservative | Extremely conservative [5|6|7].
- **Where were Democrats on the liberal to conservative scale?** (placement scale; source POLDEM1). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: Extremely liberal | Liberal | Slightly liberal [1|2|3].

C.5 Southwestern Electric Power (1996)

- **Which energy source produces the greatest amount of SWEPCO electricity?** (multiple choice; source SOURCE1). Choices: 1: Coal | 2: Wind | 3: Natural Gas | 4: Fuel Oil | 5: Nuclear | 6: Solar | 99: dk. Scored correct: Coal [1].
- **Which customer group uses the most SWEPCO electricity?** (multiple choice; source USE1). Choices: 1: Residential | 2: Commerical | 3: Industrial | 99: dk. Scored correct: Industrial [3].

- **Which SWEPCO customer group pays the highest electric rates?** (multiple choice; source RT1). Choices: 1: Residential | 2: Commerical | 3: Industrial | 99: dk. Scored correct: Residential [1].
- **Which electricity source produces the most air emissions?** (multiple choice; source SMOG1). Choices: 1: Nuclear | 2: Coal | 3: Natural Gas | 99: dk. Scored correct: Coal [2].
- **Which agency sets electric rates in Texas?** (open coded; source SETRT1). Scored correct: PUC [1]. Open answer coded into source categories; code 1 (Public Utility Commission) scored correct. Other codes scored incorrect. See R/respondent_utilities.R.

C.6 UK Monarchy (1996)

- **Is Princess Anne next in line to the throne?** (true/false; source Q5A). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: 2 false [2].
- **Is the prime minister, rather than the Queen, Britain's head of state?** (true/false; source Q5B). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: 2 false [2].
- **Is the Queen head of the Commonwealth?** (true/false; source Q5C). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: 1 true [1].
- **Is it the Queen's duty to decide the date of a general election?** (true/false; source Q5D). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: 2 false [2].
- **Does a prime minister take office only after being asked by the Queen?** (true/false; source Q5E). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: 1 true [1].
- **Is the Queen head of the Church of England?** (true/false; source Q5F). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: 1 true [1].
- **Is the Queen head of the Church of Scotland?** (true/false; source Q5G). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: 2 false [2].
- **Does Britain have an unwritten constitution?** (true/false; source Q5H). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: 1 true [1].
- **If a British monarch dies, who succeeds them?** (multiple choice; source Q8A). Choices: 1: 1 brother or siste | 2: 2 eldest brother | 3: 3 eldest sister | 4: 4 eldest child | 5: 5 eldest son | 6: 6 eldest daughter | 7: 7 none of these | 8: 8 can't choose | 9: 9 not answered. Scored correct: 5 eldest son [5].

C.7 West Texas Utilities (1996)

- **Which energy source produces the greatest amount of WTU electricity?** (multiple choice; source SOURCE1). Choices: 1: Coal | 2: Wind | 3: Natural Gas | 4: Fuel Oil | 5: Nuclear | 6: Solar | 99: dk. Scored correct: Natural Gas [3].
- **Which customer group uses the most WTU electricity?** (multiple choice; source USE1). Choices: 1: Residential | 2: Commerical | 3: Industrial | 99: dk. Scored correct: Residential [1].
- **Which WTU customer group pays the highest electric rates?** (multiple choice; source RT1). Choices: 1: Residential | 2: Commerical | 3: Industrial | 99: dk. Scored correct:

Residential [1].

- **Which electricity source produces the most air emissions?** (multiple choice; source `SMOG1`). Choices: 1: Nuclear | 2: Coal | 3: Natural Gas | 99: dk. Scored correct: Coal [2].
- **Which agency sets electric rates in Texas?** (open coded; source `SETRT1`). Scored correct: PUC [1]. Open answer coded into source categories; code 1 (Public Utility Commission) scored correct. Other codes scored incorrect. See `R/respondent_utilities.R`.

C.8 UK General Election (1997)

- **Had inflation been below five percent over the previous few years?** (true/false; source `inflat1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: True [1].
- **Did the Bank of England decide interest rates?** (true/false; source `intrst1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].
- **Was unemployment in the United Kingdom higher than in Germany?** (true/false; source `ukempl1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].
- **Where was the Conservative Party on the income redistribution scale?** (placement scale; source `redstc1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: Gov Do Nothing to Make Inc. = | | [1|2|3].
- **Where was the Conservative Party on the tax and public services scale?** (placement scale; source `taxc1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: Gov Spend Less, Cut Taxes Lot | | [1|2|3].
- **Where was the Conservative Party on the minimum wage scale?** (placement scale; source `wagec1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: Yes Min. Wage | | [1|2|3].
- **Where was the Conservative Party on the European Union scale?** (placement scale; source `euc1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: Keep Distance from E.U. | | [1|2|3].
- **Where was the Labour Party on the income redistribution scale?** (placement scale; source `redstl1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: | | Gov Try Hard Make Inc. = [5|6|7].
- **Where was the Labour Party on the tax and public services scale?** (placement scale; source `taxl1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: | | Gov Spend Lot, Tax lot [5|6|7].
- **Where was the Labour Party on the minimum wage scale?** (placement scale; source `wagel1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: Positions 5, 6, 7 [5|6|7].
- **Where was the Labour Party on the European Union scale?** (placement scale; source `eul1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: | | Unite with E.U. [5|6|7].
- **Where were the Liberal Democrats on the income redistribution scale?** (placement scale; source `redstld1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct:

| | Gov Try Hard Make Inc. = [5|6|7].

- **Where were the Liberal Democrats on the tax and public services scale?** (placement scale; source `taxld1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: | | Gov Spend Lot, Tax lot [5|6|7].
- **Where were the Liberal Democrats on the minimum wage scale?** (placement scale; source `wageld1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: Positions 5, 6, 7 [5|6|7].
- **Where were the Liberal Democrats on the European Union scale?** (placement scale; source `euld1`). Choices: See source instrument for scale endpoints. Scored correct: | | Unite with E.U. [5|6|7].

C.9 UK Health (1998)

- **Was the standard National Health Service prescription charge ten pounds?** (true/false; source `sopha1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: false [0].
- **Was the proportion of older people in Britain increasing?** (true/false; source `sophb1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: true [1].
- **Had inflation-adjusted National Health Service spending doubled in the previous 20 years?** (true/false; source `sophc1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: true [1].
- **Did most people use private medical treatment instead of the National Health Service?** (true/false; source `sophd1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: false [0].
- **Did all British women receive free breast cancer screening from the National Health Service?** (true/false; source `sophe1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: false [0].
- **Was cosmetic surgery never available through the National Health Service?** (true/false; source `sophf1`). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: false [0].

C.10 Australia Republic Referendum (1999)

- **How was the Governor-General appointed under the existing monarchy?** (multiple choice; source `qrole1`). Choices: 1: CHOOSES GOV GENERAL | 2: NO ROLE | 3: APPTS ON RECOMMEND OF PARLIAMENT | 4: APPTS ON ADVICE OF P.M. (correct) | 96: NONE | 97: DON'T KNOW. Scored correct: APPTS ON ADVICE OF P.M. (correct) [4].
- **Could the prime minister remove the proposed president?** (multiple choice; source `repres1`). Choices: 1: ANYTIME W/O REPORT TO HOUSE | 2: ANYTIME W/ LATER HOUSE APPROVE (correct) | 3: AFTER FAIR TRIAL IN PARLIAMENT | 4: CANNOT REMOVE | 96: NONE | 97: DON'T KNOW. Scored correct: ANYTIME W/ LATER HOUSE APPROVE (correct) [2].
- **Could the Governor-General dismiss the government?** (multiple choice; source `ggrole1`). Choices: 1: CONTROLS GOVERNMENT | 2: ACTS ON QUEEN'S INSTRUCTIONS | 3: PERFORMS ONLY CEREMONIAL DUTIES | 4: CAN DECIDE TO DISMISS GOVERNMENT (correct) | 96: NONE | 97: DON'T KNOW. Scored correct: CAN DECIDE TO DISMISS GOVERNMENT (correct) [4].

- **Which existing office would the proposed president most resemble?** (multiple choice; source `presrol1`). Choices: 1: BRITISH PRIME MINISTER | 2: AUSTRALIAN PRIME MINISTER | 3: AMERICAN PRESIDENT | 4: GOVERNOR GENERAL (correct) | 96: NONE | 97: DON'T KNOW. Scored correct: GOVERNOR GENERAL (correct) [4].
- **Which party was more concerned with social and welfare issues?** (multiple choice; source `welfare1`). Choices: 1: LIBERAL PARTY MORE | 2: EQUALLY CONCERNED | 3: LABOR PARTY MORE (correct) | 96: NONE | 97: NOT MUCH IMPRESSION/DONT KNOW. Scored correct: LABOR PARTY MORE (correct) [3].
- **Which party was closer to business?** (multiple choice; source `business1`). Choices: 1: LIBERAL PARTY MORE (correct) | 2: EQUALLY CLOSE | 3: LABOR PARTY MORE | 96: NONE | 97: NOT MUCH IMPRESSION/DON'T KNOW. Scored correct: LIBERAL PARTY MORE (correct) [1].
- **What public office did Aden Ridgeway hold?** (multiple choice; source `ridgeway1`). Choices: 1: LEADER OF FEDERAL OPPOSITION | 2: LEADER OF DEMOCRATS | 3: JUSTICE OF THE HIGH COURT | 4: ABORIGINAL SENATOR IN PARLIAMENT (correct) | 5: NONE OF THESE | 6: DONT KNOW | 97: DON'T KNOW. Scored correct: ABORIGINAL SENATOR IN PARLIAMENT (correct) [4].
- **What public office did Jennie George hold?** (multiple choice; source `jgeorge1`). Choices: 1: SECRETARY OF TEACHERS FEDERATION | 2: LABOR MEMBER OF FEDERAL PARLIAMENT | 3: LEADER OF WORKERS' UNION | 4: PRESIDENT OF ACTU (correct) | 5: NONE OF THESE | 97: DON'T KNOW. Scored correct: PRESIDENT OF ACTU (correct) [4].
- **Would the Australian flag change under the proposed republic?** (multiple choice; source `flagchg1`). Choices: 1: NO | 2: YES. Scored correct: NO [1].
- **Would the national anthem change under the proposed republic?** (multiple choice; source `anthem1`). Choices: 1: NO | 2: YES. Scored correct: NO [1].
- **Would use of the word Royal in military service names change under the proposed republic?** (multiple choice; source `wdroyal1`). Choices: 1: NO | 2: YES. Scored correct: YES [2].
- **Would Australian participation in the Commonwealth Games change under the proposed republic?** (multiple choice; source `pargame1`). Choices: 1: NO | 2: YES. Scored correct: NO [1].

C.11 Denmark: Euro (2000)

- **Could Denmark be fined for a large fiscal deficit as a member of the monetary union?** (multiple choice; source `s_18`). Choices: 1: true | 2: false | 3: don't know. Scored correct: true [1].
- **Could Denmark set its own interest rates after joining the monetary union?** (multiple choice; source `s_19`). Choices: 1: true | 2: false | 3: don't know. Scored correct: false [2].
- **Could Denmark set its own tax rates after joining the single currency?** (multiple choice; source `s_20`). Choices: 1: true | 2: false | 3: don't know. Scored correct: true [1].

- **Would a yes vote in September 2000 cause euro notes and coins to circulate in 2001?** (multiple choice; source s_21). Choices: 1: 2001 | 2: 2004 (korrekt svar) | 3: 2005 | 4: 2007 | 5: don't know. Scored correct: 2004 (korrekt svar) [2].
- **What would happen to the Danish National Bank if Denmark joined the single currency?** (multiple choice; source s_22). Choices: 1: be close down | 2: continue to operate pretty much like now | 3: become part of european central bank | 4: don't know. Scored correct: become part of european central bank [3].
- **Would euro coins have a national side?** (multiple choice; source s_23). Choices: 1: Yes | 2: no | 3: don't know. Scored correct: Yes [1].
- **Did the Socialist People's Party recommend a yes or no vote on adopting the euro?** (multiple choice; source s_25_07). Choices: 1: Recommend Yes | 2: Recommend No | 3: Don't know. Scored correct: Recommend No [2].
- **Did the Christian People's Party recommend a yes or no vote on adopting the euro?** (multiple choice; source s_25_09). Choices: 1: Recommend Yes | 2: Recommend No | 3: Don't know. Scored correct: Recommend No [2].
- **Did the Progress Party recommend a yes or no vote on adopting the euro?** (multiple choice; source s_25_11). Choices: 1: Recommend Yes | 2: Recommend No | 3: Don't know. Scored correct: Recommend No [2].

C.12 Bulgarian National Crime Poll (2002)

- **Could police detain a citizen for questioning at any hour without allowing refusal?** (true/false; source q12_1). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].
- **Could a court detain a suspect indefinitely while proving guilt?** (true/false; source q12_2). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].
- **Could prosecutors detain a suspect until a case was resolved?** (true/false; source q12_3). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].
- **Was the chief prosecutor accountable to parliament?** (true/false; source q12_4). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].
- **Were police forbidden to use violence against a detainee even if the person was guilty?** (true/false; source q12_5). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: True [1].
- **Could police detain a person for 72 hours?** (true/false; source q12_6). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: False [2].
- **Was a confession alone insufficient to establish guilt?** (true/false; source q12_7). Choices: True | False. Scored correct: True [1].

C.13 By the People: National (2003)

- **Where did the Democratic Party stand on a 0–10 scale from doing nothing about global warming to acting now?** (placement scale; source qb15b). Choices: 0–10 scale: 0 = do nothing | 5 = midway | 10 = act now. Scored correct: Above midpoint [6|7|8|9|10].

- **Where did the Republican Party stand on a 0–10 scale from doing nothing about global warming to acting now?** (placement scale; source qb15c). Choices: 0–10 scale: 0 = do nothing | 5 = midway | 10 = act now. Scored correct: Below midpoint [0|1|2|3|4].
- **Did President Bush want to increase, decrease, or maintain foreign aid?** (multiple choice; source qb26). Choices: 1: increase | 2: decrease | 3: keep it the same | 4: haven't heard anything about this. Scored correct: increase [1].
- **Did President Bush support recent international agreements to control greenhouse gases?** (multiple choice; source qb18). Choices: 1: supports | 2: opposes | 3: haven't heard anything about this. Scored correct: opposes [2].
- **How much of each \$100 in the federal budget went to military spending?** (multiple choice; source qb40). Choices: 1: 1 dollar, | 2: 5 dollars, | 3: 10 dollars, | 4: 20 dollars, | 5: 30 dollars or more, or | 6: don't you have much idea about that?. Scored correct: 20 dollars, [4].
- **How much of each \$100 in the federal budget went to foreign aid?** (multiple choice; source qb41). Choices: 1: 1 dollar, | 2: 5 dollars, | 3: 10 dollars, | 4: 20 dollars, | 5: 30 dollars or more, or | 6: don't you have much idea about that?. Scored correct: 1 dollar, [1].
- **How much of each \$100 of United States output was sold abroad?** (multiple choice; source qb42). Choices: 1: 4 dollars worth, | 2: 8 dollars, | 3: 12 dollars, | 4: 24 dollars or more, or | 5: don't you have much idea about that?. Scored correct: 12 dollars, [3].
- **About how many adults per 100 in the most affected African countries had HIV/AIDS?** (multiple choice; source qb43). Choices: 1: fewer than 5 out of 100, | 2: about 10 of 100, | 3: about 20 of 100, | 4: 30 or more out of 100, or | 5: don't you have much idea about that?. Scored correct: 30 or more out of 100, or [4].
- **Did the United States have a veto over World Trade Organization decisions?** (multiple choice; source qb44). Choices: 1: true | 2: false. Scored correct: false [2].
- **Did the United States have a veto on the United Nations Security Council?** (multiple choice; source qb45). Choices: 1: true | 2: false. Scored correct: true [1].
- **What was the main cause of global warming?** (multiple choice; source qb12). Choices: 1: it is caused mostly by human activities, like driving cars a | 2: it is caused mostly by natural changes in the climate, | 3: it is not occurring at all, or | 4: haven't you thought much about this?. Scored correct: it is caused mostly by human activities, like driving cars a [1].

C.14 National Issues Convention 2 (2003)

- **Where did the Democratic Party stand on the global warming action scale?** (placement scale; source wrm3_b). Choices: 98: don't know. Scored correct: Above midpoint [6|7|8|9|10].
- **Where did the Republican Party stand on the global warming action scale?** (placement scale; source wrm3_c). Choices: 98: don't know. Scored correct: Below midpoint [0|1|2|3|4].
- **Did President Bush want to increase, decrease, or maintain foreign aid?** (multiple choice; source aid3). Choices: 1: increase | 2: decrease | 3: keep it the same | 4: haven't

heard anything about this | 8: don't know. Scored correct: increase [1].

- **Did President Bush support recent international agreements to control greenhouse gases?** (multiple choice; source wrm5). Choices: 1: supports | 3: opposes | 5: haven't heard anything about this | 8: don't know. Scored correct: opposes [3].
- **How much of each \$100 in the federal budget went to military spending?** (multiple choice; source kno1_a). Choices: 1: 1 dollar | 2: 5 dollars | 3: 10 dollars | 4: 20 dollars | 5: 30+ dollars | 6: not much idea | 7: vol: other amount (specify) | 8: don't know. Scored correct: 20 dollars [4].
- **How much of each \$100 in the federal budget went to foreign aid?** (multiple choice; source kno1_b). Choices: 1: 1 dollar | 2: 5 dollars | 3: 10 dollars | 4: 20 dollars | 5: 30+ dollars | 6: not much idea | 7: vol: other amount (specify) | 8: don't know. Scored correct: 1 dollar [1].
- **How much of each \$100 of United States output was sold abroad?** (multiple choice; source kno2_a). Choices: 1: 4 dollars | 2: 8 dollars | 3: 12 dollars | 4: 24+ dollars | 5: not much idea | 7: vol: other amount (specify) | 8: don't know. Scored correct: 12 dollars [3].
- **About how many adults per 100 in the most affected African countries had HIV/AIDS?** (multiple choice; source kno2_b). Choices: 1: fewer than 5 out of 100 | 2: about 10 of 100 | 3: about 20 of 100 | 4: 30+ out of 100 | 5: not much idea | 7: vol: other amount (specify) | 8: don't know. Scored correct: 30+ out of 100 [4].
- **Did the United States have a veto over World Trade Organization decisions?** (multiple choice; source kno3_a). Choices: 1: true | 5: false | 8: don't know. Scored correct: false [5].
- **Did the United States have a veto on the United Nations Security Council?** (multiple choice; source kno3_b). Choices: 1: true | 5: false | 8: don't know. Scored correct: true [1].
- **What was the main cause of global warming?** (multiple choice; source wrm1_b). Choices: 1: human activities | 2: natural changes | 3: not occurring at all | 4: haven't thought much about this | 8: don't know. Scored correct: human activities [1].

C.15 By the People 2004 Online Primaries (2004)

- **What did President Bush's tax cut do to taxes on investment income?** (multiple choice; source b1q43). Choices: 1: lower it | 2: keep it the same | 3: raise it | 4: don't know. Scored correct: lower it [1].
- **What was Wesley Clark's most recent government position?** (multiple choice; source b1q44). Choices: 1: senator from arkansas | 2: secretary of the air force | 3: supreme allied commander of nato | 4: national security advisor to the president | 5: don't know. Scored correct: supreme allied commander of nato [3].
- **Why did President Bush end tariffs on imported steel?** (multiple choice; source b1q45). Choices: 1: the steel industry and steelworkers unions objected | 2: he wanted to avoid increased tariffs by the european union o | 3: domestic steel production is insufficient to meet demand, th | 4: he has never supported tariffs | 5: don't know. Scored correct: he wanted to avoid increased tariffs by the european union o [2].

- **Which Democratic presidential candidate had served as House majority leader?** (multiple choice; source b1q46). Choices: 1: john edwards | 2: howard dean | 3: joe lieberman | 4: richard gephardt | 5: don't know. Scored correct: richard gephardt [4].
- **How had the unemployment rate changed since President Bush took office?** (multiple choice; source b1q47). Choices: 1: decreased | 2: stayed about the same | 3: increased | 4: don't know. Scored correct: increased [3].
- **How many Americans had been killed in action in Iraq?** (multiple choice; source b1q48). Choices: 1: fewer than a hundred | 2: several hundred | 3: several thousand | 4: more than twenty thousand | 5: don't know. Scored correct: several hundred [2].
- **What was the Bush administration's position on a Free Trade Area of the Americas?** (multiple choice; source b1q49). Choices: 1: support it | 2: neither support nor oppose it | 3: oppose it | 4: don't know. Scored correct: support it [1].

C.16 By the People 2004 US General Election (2004)

- **How did John Kerry vote on the Senate resolution authorizing the Iraq war?** (multiple choice; source w4b60). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: vote for it | 2: vote against it | 3: not vote on it | 4: blank | 5: don't know. Scored correct: vote for it [1].
- **Which country harbored the most Al Qaeda and Taliban fighters?** (multiple choice; source w4b61). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: india | 2: pakistan | 3: sri lanka | 4: indonesia | 5: blank | 6: don't know. Scored correct: pakistan [2].
- **Was Iraq directly involved in the September 11 attacks?** (multiple choice; source w4b62). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: true | 2: false | 3: blank | 4: don't know. Scored correct: false [2].
- **Had large quantities of weapons of mass destruction been found in Iraq?** (multiple choice; source w4b63). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: true | 2: false | 3: blank | 4: don't know. Scored correct: false [2].
- **Did prescription drugs cost more in Canada than in the United States?** (multiple choice; source w4b64). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: true | 2: false | 3: blank | 4: don't know. Scored correct: false [2].
- **What was George W. Bush's role during the Vietnam War?** (multiple choice; source w4b65). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: he was drafted but never went to vietnam | 2: he was a decorated officer serving in vietnam | 3: he was ineligible to serve in the military because of a medi | 4: he served in the texas air national guard | 5: blank | 6: don't know. Scored correct: he served in the texas air national guard [4].
- **What was John Kerry's role during the Vietnam War?** (multiple choice; source w4b66). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: he was drafted but never went to vietnam | 2: he was a decorated officer serving in vietnam | 3: he was ineligible to serve in the military because of a medi | 4: he served in

the massachusetts air national guard | 5: blank | 6: don't know. Scored correct: he was a decorated officer serving in vietnam [2].

- **Which country was a major destination for offshore white-collar jobs?** (multiple choice; source w4b68). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: south africa | 2: japan | 3: brazil | 4: india | 5: blank | 6: don't know. Scored correct: india [4].
- **About how many Americans had been killed in Iraq since the war began?** (multiple choice; source w4b69). Choices: -4: case in not in wave of data collection | -3: case in wave, no survey on file | 1: 100 | 2: 500 | 3: 1,000 | 4: 10,000 | 5: blank | 6: don't know. Scored correct: 1,000 [3].

C.17 By the People 2004 US Presidential Primaries (2004)

- **What did President Bush's tax cut do to taxes on investment income?** (multiple choice; source b1q43). Choices: 1: lower it | 2: keep it the same | 3: raise it | 4: don't know. Scored correct: lower it [1].
- **What was Wesley Clark's most recent government position?** (multiple choice; source b1q44). Choices: 1: senator from arkansas | 2: secretary of the air force | 3: supreme allied commander of nato | 4: national security advisor to the president | 5: don't know. Scored correct: supreme allied commander of nato [3].
- **Why did President Bush end tariffs on imported steel?** (multiple choice; source b1q45). Choices: 1: the steel industry and steelworkers unions objected | 2: he wanted to avoid increased tariffs by the european union o | 3: domestic steel production is insufficient to meet demand, th | 4: he has never supported tariffs | 5: don't know. Scored correct: he wanted to avoid increased tariffs by the european union o [2].
- **Which Democratic presidential candidate had served as House majority leader?** (multiple choice; source b1q46). Choices: 1: john edwards | 2: howard dean | 3: joe lieberman | 4: richard gephardt | 5: don't know. Scored correct: richard gephardt [4].
- **How had the unemployment rate changed since President Bush took office?** (multiple choice; source b1q47). Choices: 1: decreased | 2: stayed about the same | 3: increased | 4: don't know. Scored correct: increased [3].
- **How many Americans had been killed in action in Iraq?** (multiple choice; source b1q48). Choices: 1: fewer than a hundred | 2: several hundred | 3: several thousand | 4: more than twenty thousand | 5: don't know. Scored correct: several hundred [2].
- **What was the Bush administration's position on a Free Trade Area of the Americas?** (multiple choice; source b1q49). Choices: 1: support it | 2: neither support nor oppose it | 3: oppose it | 4: don't know. Scored correct: support it [1].

C.18 New Haven, CT (2004)

- **Which population estimate is closest to that of the greater New Haven region?** (multiple choice; source pre_q35). Choices: 1: 250,000 | 2: 350,000 | 3: 550,000 | 4: 750,000. Scored correct: 550,000 [3].

- **Was New Haven regional job growth in the 1990s greater than, similar to, or less than the rest of the United States?** (multiple choice; source pre_q36). Choices: 1: More | 2: About the same | 3: Less. Scored correct: About the same [2].
- **What is the main source of revenue for most town governments in greater New Haven?** (multiple choice; source pre_q37). Choices: 1: Sales taxes | 2: Property taxes | 3: State subsidies | 4: Federal subsidies. Scored correct: Property taxes [2].
- **Did the population of New Haven city increase, stay the same, or decrease in the 1990s?** (multiple choice; source pre_q39). Choices: 1: Increased | 2: Stayed the same | 3: Decreased. Scored correct: Decreased [3].
- **Does Connecticut law allow communities to share property tax revenues?** (multiple choice; source pre_q40). Choices: 1: Yes | 2: No. Scored correct: Yes [1].
- **Do communities with the most valuable property tend to have the lowest, average, or highest property tax rates?** (multiple choice; source pre_q41). Choices: 1: Lowest | 2: Average | 3: Highest. Scored correct: Lowest [1].
- **How does the Federal Aviation Authority classify Tweed New Haven Airport?** (multiple choice; source pre_q42). Choices: 1: Major hub | 2: Medium hub | 3: Minor hub | 4: Non-hub. Scored correct: Non-hub [4].
- **Would maintaining Tweed New Haven Airport at its current level of service require significant investment?** (multiple choice; source pre_q43). Choices: 1: Yes | 2: No. Scored correct: Yes [1].

C.19 By the People: Health and Education (2005)

- **Where did the United States rank among wealthy countries in student mathematics skills?** (multiple choice; source q15). Choices: 1: bottom 3 | 2: bottom 10 | 3: top 10 | 4: top 3 | 7: dk. Scored correct: bottom 10 [2].
- **Had it become harder or easier for foreigners to get United States work permits?** (multiple choice; source q16). Choices: 1: harder | 2: same | 3: easier | 7: dk. Scored correct: harder [1].
- **Had the minority–White gap in elementary mathematics and reading scores widened?** (multiple choice; source q17). Choices: 1: increasing | 2: same | 3: decreasing | 7: dk. Scored correct: increasing [1].
- **About how many Americans lacked health insurance?** (multiple choice; source q26). Choices: 1: 1 million | 2: 25 million | 3: 45 million | 4: 65 million | 5: 85 million | 7: dk. Scored correct: 45 million [3].
- **How much was the population age 65 and older expected to grow over the next 50 years?** (multiple choice; source q27). Choices: 1: stay about the same | 2: increase by about half | 3: double | 4: triple | 7: dk. Scored correct: double [3].
- **What share of uninsured families had low incomes?** (multiple choice; source q28). Choices: 1: a quarter | 2: fifty per cent | 3: two thirds | 4: ninety per cent | 7: dk. Scored correct: two thirds [3].

C.20 Zeguo Township (2005)

- **By how much did Zeguo Township revenue increase from 2003 to 2004?** (multiple choice; source pre_d3043). Choices: 1: 10.2% | 2: 20.1% | 3: 33.7% | 4: No increase. Scored correct: 33.7% [3].
- **How large is the floating population in Zeguo Township?** (multiple choice; source pre_d3044). Choices: 1: 300,000 | 2: 50,000 | 3: 120,000 | 4: 200,000. Scored correct: 120,000 [3].
- **Which listed product is not a major product of Zeguo Township?** (multiple choice; source pre_d3045). Choices: 1: Water pumps | 2: Shoes | 3: Plastic products | 4: Air compressors. Scored correct: Plastic products [3].
- **How many parks does Zeguo Township currently have?** (multiple choice; source pre_d3046). Choices: 1: Zero | 2: One | 3: Two | 4: Five | 5: Seven. Scored correct: Two parks [3].

C.21 By the People 2007 (2007)

- **About how many Americans were prevented from voting because of criminal convictions?** (multiple choice; source PRE_Q19). Choices: 1: 50,000 | 2: 500,000 | 3: 5,000,000 | 4: 15,000,000 | 99: Couldn't say. Scored correct: 5,000,000 [3].
- **What was the purpose of gerrymandering?** (multiple choice; source PRE_Q20). Choices: 1: Increase electoral competition | 2: Ensure a majority for one party over another | 3: Include independents in the primary process | 4: Make them much smaller | 99: Couldn't say. Scored correct: Ensure a majority for one party over another [2].
- **What share of eligible voters voted in the specified presidential election?** (multiple choice; source PRE_Q21). Choices: 1: 10% | 2: 30% | 3: 50% | 4: 70% | 99: Couldn't say. Scored correct: 50% [3].
- **Which listed country had compulsory voting?** (multiple choice; source PRE_Q22). Choices: 1: Ireland | 2: United Kingdom | 3: Australia | 4: South Korea | 99: Couldn't say. Scored correct: Australia [3].
- **Who had to register with Selective Service in the United States?** (multiple choice; source PRE_Q23). Choices: 1: Nobody | 2: Men between 18 and 25 years old | 3: Both men and women between 18 and 25 years old | 4: Men and women who receive federal grants for education | 99: Couldn't say. Scored correct: Men between 18 and 25 years old [2].
- **What vote total must a United States presidential candidate receive to win?** (multiple choice; source PRE_Q24). Choices: 1: Gets more votes than any other candidate | 2: Gets a majority of all the votes cast | 3: Gets more Electoral College votes than any other candidate | 4: Gets a majority of Electoral College votes | 99: Couldn't say. Scored correct: Gets a majority of Electoral College votes [4].
- **How often are congressional districts redrawn?** (multiple choice; source PRE_Q25). Choices: 1: Every 5 years | 2: Every 10 years | 3: Every 15 years | 4: Every 20 years | 99: Couldn't say. Scored correct: Every 10 years [2].
- **Which two states held the earliest presidential primary events?** (multiple choice;

source PRE_Q26). Choices: 1: Nevada and South Carolina | 2: Iowa and New Hampshire | 3: Indiana and New Mexico | 4: Wyoming and Delaware | 5: Michigan and Florida | 99: Couldn't say. Scored correct: Iowa and New Hampshire [2].

C.22 Northern Ireland (2007)

- **What share of Northern Ireland schools had mostly Protestant or mostly Catholic pupils?** (multiple choice; source t1q21). Choices: 1: more than 50% | 2: 40-50% | 3: 20-30% | 4: 5-10% | 5: less than 1% | 9: don't know. Scored correct: 5-10% [4]. Archived variable/value labels are truncated; the listed substantive choices are partial transcriptions. The key is the archived numeric code.
- **By about what percentage had the number of children entering Omagh schools changed?** (multiple choice; source t1q22). Choices: 1: increased by 20% | 2: increased by 10% | 3: stayed about the same | 4: decreased by 10% | 5: decreased by 20% | 9: don't know. Scored correct: decreased by 10% [4]. Archived variable/value labels are truncated; the listed substantive choices are partial transcriptions. The key is the archived numeric code.
- **What did the new entitlement framework require for the school curriculum?** (multiple choice; source t1q23). Choices: 1: every school provides all 14-year-olds with a choice of at l | 2: every child has the right to attend any school his or her pa | 3: every child be provided a free school meal every school day | 4: every child receives free textbooks | 9: don't know. Scored correct: every school provides all 14-year-olds with a choice of at l... [1]. Archived variable/value labels are truncated; the listed substantive choices are partial transcriptions. The key is the archived numeric code.
- **What did the new entitlement framework require for access to courses?** (multiple choice; source t1q24). Choices: 1: every child receives tuition in the language of his or her p | 2: every child receives free transportation to and from school | 3: every denominational group has the right to run its own scho | 4: one-third of all the subjects offered must be applied | 9: don't know. Scored correct: one-third of all the subjects offered must be applied... [4]. Archived variable/value labels are truncated; the listed substantive choices are partial transcriptions. The key is the archived numeric code.
- **What did pupils in Northern Ireland typically do after compulsory schooling?** (multiple choice; source t1q25). Choices: 1: about one-quarter go directly into employment | 2: about one-quarter leave school to be unemployed | 3: about three-quarters of grammar school pupils attend univers | 4: about three-quarters of secondary school students attend fur | 9: don't know. Scored correct: about three-quarters of grammar school pupils attend univers... [3]. Archived variable/value labels are truncated; the listed substantive choices are partial transcriptions. The key is the archived numeric code.
- **Which statement about Northern Ireland school funding was correct?** (multiple choice; source t1q26). Choices: 1: schools receive more funding for older pupils | 2: schools receive the same funding for all pupils, regardless | 3: schools receive more funding for younger pupils | 9: don't know. Scored correct: schools receive more funding for older pupils [1]. Archived variable/value labels are truncated; the listed substantive choices are partial transcriptions. The key is the archived numeric code.
- **Which statement about the employing authority for Northern Ireland schools was correct?** (multiple choice; source t1q27). Choices: 1: the official employer for all teachers

is the education and | 2: the official employer for all teachers is the department of | 3: the official employer for all teachers in catholic schools | 4: the official employer for all teachers in voluntary grammar | 9: don't know. Scored correct: the official employer for all teachers in voluntary grammar... [4]. Archived variable/value labels are truncated; the listed substantive choices are partial transcriptions. The key is the archived numeric code.

C.23 Tomorrow's Europe (EU) (2007)

- **Which listed country was an official candidate to join the European Union?** (multiple choice; source q16_1). Choices: 1: Romania | 2: Montenegro | 3: Croatia | 4: Morocco | 5: Or couldn't you say about that ? | 6: REF | 7: DK. Scored correct: Croatia [3].
- **How were members of the European Parliament chosen?** (multiple choice; source q17_1). Choices: 1: Directly elected by the citizens of their country | 2: Elected for three year terms | 3: Elected by the parliament of their country | 4: Appointed by their national head of government | 5: Or couldn't you say about that ? | 6: REF | 7: DK. Scored correct: Directly elected by the citizens of their country [1].
- **Which European Union institutions adopted employment laws?** (multiple choice; source q18_1). Choices: 1: The European Commission, in some cases with the European Parliament | 2: The Council of Ministers, in some cases with the European Parliament | 3: The European Parliament by itself | 4: The European commission by itself | 5: Or couldn't you say about that ? | 6: REF | 7: DK. Scored correct: The Council of Ministers, in some cases with the European Parliament [2].
- **What was the European Union's role in unemployment benefits?** (multiple choice; source q19_1). Choices: 1: Finance the member states unemployment benefit systems | 2: Decide the level and length of unemployment benefits in the member states | 3: Require that the member states merge their unemployment benefit systems by 2010 | 4: Guarantee that all EU citizens have access to unemployment benefits where they live | 5: Or couldn't say about that ? | 6: REF | 7: DK. Scored correct: Guarantee that all EU citizens have access to unemployment benefits where they live [4].
- **To what was roughly one-third of the European Union budget devoted?** (multiple choice; source q20_1). Choices: 1: Helping the EU's less prosperous regions | 2: Subsidizing the EU's fishing industry | 3: Financing diplomatic missions abroad | 4: Maintaining the EU's administration and bureaucracy | 5: Or couldn't you say about that ? | 6: REF | 7: DK. Scored correct: Helping the EU's less prosperous regions [1].
- **How was the share of European Union adults age 65 or older expected to change by 2050?** (multiple choice; source q21_1). Choices: 1: About one quarter of what it is now | 2: About half of what it is now | 3: About the same as what it is now | 4: About twice what it is now | 5: About four times what it is now | 6: Or couldn't you say about that ? | 7: REF | 8: DK. Scored correct: About twice what it is now [4].
- **How much foreign aid did the European Union and its members give relative to the United States?** (multiple choice; source q22_1). Choices: 1: The EU and its member states give roughly four times as much | 2: The EU and its member states give roughly twice as much | 3: The EU and its member states and the US give about the same amount | 4: The US gives roughly twice as much | 5: The US gives roughly four times as much | 6: Or couldn't

t you say about that ? | 7: REF | 8: DK. Scored correct: The EU and its member states give roughly twice as much [2].

- **About what share of European Union member governments' spending went to foreign aid?** (multiple choice; source q23_1). Choices: 1: About 1% | 2: About 5% | 3: About 9% | 4: About 13% | 5: About 17% | 6: Or couldn't you say about that ? | 7: REF | 8: DK. Scored correct: About 1% [1].
- **Which listed country did not possess nuclear weapons?** (multiple choice; source q24_1). Choices: 1: Pakistan | 2: India | 3: North Korea | 4: Japan | 5: Or couldn't you say about that ? | 6: REF | 7: DK. Scored correct: Japan [4].
- **Where was Nicolas Sarkozy on the left to right political scale?** (placement scale; source q33a_1). Choices: 1: 0 | 2: 1 | 3: 2 | 4: 3 | 5: 4 | 6: 5 | 7: 6 | 8: 7 | 9: 8 | 10: 9 | 11: 10 | 12: REF | 13: DK. Scored correct: 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 [7|8|9|10|11].
- **Where was Gordon Brown on the left to right political scale?** (placement scale; source q33b_1). Choices: 1: 0 | 2: 1 | 3: 2 | 4: 3 | 5: 4 | 6: 5 | 7: 6 | 8: 7 | 9: 8 | 10: 9 | 11: 10 | 12: REF | 13: DK. Scored correct: 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 [1|2|3|4|5].

C.24 Vermont Energy (2007)

- **What was the surcharge on Vermont electricity bills?** (multiple choice; source Q77). Choices: 1: Almost no impact | 2: Reduced by 20% | 3: Reduced by 50% | 4: Reduced by 70% | 5: Reduced by 90% | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: Reduced by 20% [2].
- **What was the effect of the Vermont energy-efficiency program?** (multiple choice; source Q78). Choices: 1: Almost no impact | 2: Reduced by 20% | 3: Reduced by 50% | 4: Reduced by 70% | 5: Reduced by 90% | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: Reduced by 50% [3].
- **What share of electricity came from renewable sources?** (multiple choice; source Q79). Choices: 1: 5% | 2: 15% | 3: 25% | 4: 40% | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: 15% | 25% [2|3].
- **What share of electricity came from the Vermont Yankee nuclear plant?** (multiple choice; source Q80). Choices: 1: 5% | 2: 15% | 3: 25% | 4: 40% | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: 40% [4].
- **What share of electricity came from Hydro-Québec?** (multiple choice; source Q81). Choices: 1: 5% | 2: 15% | 3: 25% | 4: 40% | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: 15% [2].
- **What share of electricity was produced within Vermont?** (multiple choice; source Q82). Choices: 1: 5% | 2: 15% | 3: 25% | 4: 40% | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: 25% [3].
- **How did Vermont electricity rates compare with the rest of New England?** (multiple choice; source Q83). Choices: 1: Roughly 10% higher | 2: Roughly 20% higher | 3: About the same | 4: Roughly 10% lower | 5: Roughly 20% lower | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: Roughly 10% lower [4].

- **What was the average Vermont household electricity bill?** (multiple choice; source Q84). Choices: 1: Roughly \$60 | 2: Roughly \$80 | 3: Roughly \$120 | 4: Roughly \$180 | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: Roughly \$80 [2].
- **When did the Vermont Yankee contract expire?** (multiple choice; source Q85). Choices: 1: 2010 | 2: 2012 | 3: 2018 | 4: 2025 | 8: No Opinion / Don't Know. Scored correct: 2012 [2].

C.25 San Mateo, CA (2008)

- **What was the yearly gap between new homes needed and homes built in San Mateo County?** (multiple choice; source Q19). Choices: 1: about 200 | 2: about 500 | 3: about 1,000 | 4: about 5,000 | 5: about 8,000 | 6: Or couldn't you say about that?. Scored correct: about 1,000 [3].
- **What was the median single-family home price in San Mateo County in 2007?** (multiple choice; source Q20). Choices: 1: 550,000 | 2: 680,000 | 3: 750,000 | 4: 830,000 | 5: 950,000 | 6: Or couldn't you say about that?. Scored correct: 950,000 [5].
- **What share of county households could afford a median-priced home in 2006?** (multiple choice; source Q21). Choices: 1: 12% | 2: 23% | 3: 37% | 4: 43% | 5: 55% | 6: Or couldn't you say about that?. Scored correct: 12% [1].
- **What was the average rent for a two-bedroom apartment in 2007?** (multiple choice; source Q22). Choices: 1: \$1,100 | 2: \$1,300 | 3: \$1,700 | 4: \$2,200 | 5: \$3,000 | 6: Or couldn't you say about that?. Scored correct: \$1,700 [3].
- **How much was county housing demand projected to grow from 2005 to 2025?** (multiple choice; source Q23). Choices: 1: 20,000 | 2: 40,000 | 3: 60,000 | 4: 70,000 | 5: 90,000 | 6: Or couldn't you say about that?. Scored correct: 70,000 [4].
- **What share of projected new households would have low or very low incomes?** (multiple choice; source Q24). Choices: 1: Less than one-third | 2: Less than one-half | 3: About half | 4: More than one-half | 5: More than two-thirds | 6: Or couldn't you say about that?. Scored correct: About half [3].
- **How many new homes were projected to be built at the current development rate?** (multiple choice; source Q25). Choices: 1: 25,000 | 2: 50,000 | 3: 75,000 | 4: 100,000 | 5: Or couldn't you say about that?. Scored correct: 25,000 [1].
- **What share of county land was open space or other protected land?** (multiple choice; source Q26). Choices: 1: less than 25% | 2: 33% | 3: 58% | 4: 67% | 5: more than 75% | 6: Or couldn't you say about that?. Scored correct: more than 75% [5].

C.26 Europolis (2009)

- **V1Q43. Is the main decision-making body of the European Union the...?** (multiple choice; source V1Q43). Choices: 1: European Commission | 2: Council of Ministers | 3: European Parliament | 4: European Court of Auditors | 999: You couldn't say. Scored correct: Council of Ministers [2].
- **V1Q44. Only one of the following statements about the European Parliament is false. Which one is it?** (multiple choice; source V1Q44). Choices: 1: It passes all EU laws | 2: It can dismiss the European Commission | 3: It can reject the budget proposed by the

Council of Minister | 4: It is involved in decisions about the admission of new Membe | 999: You couldn't say. Scored correct: It passes all EU laws [1].

- **V1Q46. Which of the following is true of Blue card workers?** (multiple choice; source V1Q46). Choices: 1: They can work anywhere in the EU | 2: They must have a university education | 3: They cannot bring family members to join them any faster tha | 4: They are subject to the Returns Directive | 999: You couldn't say. Scored correct: They must have a university education [2].
- **V1Q47. Which of the following is true about the ways in which immigration policy is currently made?** (multiple choice; source V1Q47). Choices: 1: The EU sets the basic rules about entry and residency requir | 2: The EU decides how many immigrants can be admitted to each c | 3: Work permits for immigrants must be approved by the EU | 4: The EU plays no role in immigration policy. | 999: You couldn't say. Scored correct: The EU sets the basic rules about entry and residency requir [1].
- **V1Q49. The percentage of the EU's total energy consumption that comes from fossil fuels (coal, gas or oil) is about...?** (multiple choice; source V1Q49). Choices: 1: 50% | 2: 60% | 3: 70% | 4: 80% | 999: You couldn't say. Scored correct: 80% [4].
- **V1Q50. Which of the following produces the most greenhouse gases?** (multiple choice; source V1Q50). Choices: 1: China | 2: The European Union | 3: The United States | 4: India | 999: You couldn't say. Scored correct: China [1].

C.27 Michigan (2009)

- **Which party held the majority in the Michigan State Senate?** (open text; source q14). Scored correct: Republican Party [2]. Open party name at departure was lowercased and stripped of punctuation; explicit party spellings in metadata/knowledge_items.csv were accepted. The baseline source stores a coded party category, shown in correct_codes.
- **Which party held the majority in the Michigan State House of Representatives?** (open text; source q15). Scored correct: Democratic Party [1]. Open party name at departure was lowercased and stripped of punctuation; explicit party spellings in metadata/knowledge_items.csv were accepted. The baseline source stores a coded party category, shown in correct_codes.
- **Which state had an unemployment rate similar to Michigan?** (multiple choice; source q16). Choices: 1: Oregon | 2: West Virginia | 3: Ohio | 4: Louisiana. Scored correct: Oregon [1].
- **Under which condition could a person remain eligible for the Family Independence Program after 48 months?** (multiple choice; source q17). Choices: 1: Live in a county with high unemployment | 2: Fired from a job while on the Family Self-Sufficiency Plan | 3: Non-citizen on the Refugee Assistance Program | 4: Have a small child in the ChildFirst program. Scored correct: Live in a county with high unemployment [1].
- **About what percentage of African American children in Michigan lived in poverty?** (multiple choice; source q18). Choices: 1: Under 20% | 2: About 30% | 3: About 40% | 4: Over 50%. Scored correct: About 40% [3].
- **Where was the Democratic Party on the 1–7 scale from lower taxes and services**

to higher taxes and services? (placement scale; source q4). Choices: 1–7 placement scale; endpoints in question. Scored correct: Positions 5, 6, 7 [5|6|7].

- **Where was the Republican Party on the 1–7 scale from lower taxes and services to higher taxes and services?** (placement scale; source q5). Choices: 1–7 placement scale; endpoints in question. Scored correct: Positions 1, 2, 3 [1|2|3].
- **Where was the Democratic Party on the 1–7 scale from government action to reduce unemployment to letting the economy recover?** (placement scale; source q7). Choices: 1–7 placement scale; endpoints in question. Scored correct: Positions 1, 2, 3 [1|2|3].
- **Where was the Republican Party on the 1–7 scale from government action to reduce unemployment to letting the economy recover?** (placement scale; source q8). Choices: 1–7 placement scale; endpoints in question. Scored correct: Positions 5, 6, 7 [5|6|7].

C.28 California What’s Next (2011)

- **Which party held the majority in the California State Senate?** (multiple choice; source q37). Choices: 1: Republican Party | 2: Democratic Party | 98: Don’t Know/ Couldn’t Say. Scored correct: Democratic Party [2].
- **Which party held the majority in the California State Assembly?** (multiple choice; source q38). Choices: 1: Republican Party | 2: Democratic Party | 98: Don’t Know/ Couldn’t Say. Scored correct: Democratic Party [2].
- **What legislative majority was needed to approve the proposed state budget?** (multiple choice; source q39). Choices: 1: Simple Majority of Both Houses | 2: Simple Majority Assembly & Two-Thirds Senate | 3: Two-Thirds of Both Houses | 4: Three-Fourths of Both Houses | 98: Don’t Know/ Couldn’t Say. Scored correct: Two-Thirds of Both Houses [3].
- **What legislative majority was needed to raise taxes?** (multiple choice; source q40). Choices: 1: Simple Majority of Both Houses | 2: Simple Majority Assembly & Two-Thirds Senate | 3: Two-Thirds of Both Houses | 4: Three-Fourths of Both Houses | 98: Don’t Know/ Couldn’t Say. Scored correct: Two-Thirds of Both Houses [3].
- **Who could sign a ballot measure?** (multiple choice; source q41). Choices: 1: Anyone 18+ | 2: Any Citizen 18+ | 3: Only Registered Voters | 4: Only Registered Voters Who Voted in Last Election | 98: Don’t Know/ Couldn’t Say. Scored correct: Only Registered Voters [3].